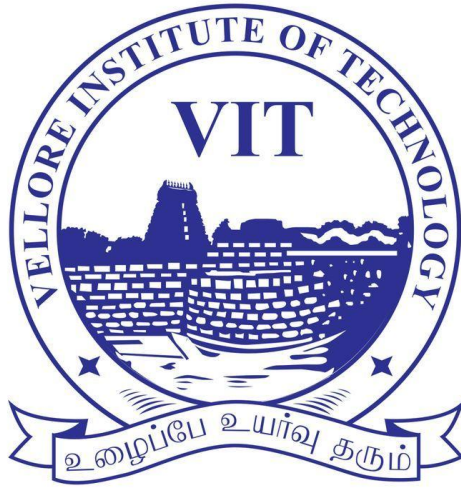




Project Report

Digital Literacy

CSE0001

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BRANCH - ELECTRONIC AND COMMUNICATION

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INTRODUCTION

My digital literacy awareness project focuses on educating people about the safe, responsible, and effective use of digital technologies. The project highlights important topics such as safe internet practices, proper online communication, and the use of digital tools for learning and productivity. I used tools like ChatGPT, Canva, and GitHub to create and organize my work. The main aim of this project is to spread awareness among students about how to use digital resources wisely while avoiding risks like cyber threats and misuse of information. Through this project, I also learned new skills such as designing, researching, and managing content online.

TASK -1

- I used digital tools like **ChatGPT, Canva, and Google Gemini** to create my design. These tools helped me generate ideas, design visuals, and improve my content easily and efficiently. My design focuses on digital literacy awareness, showing how important it is for students to use technology safely, responsibly, and effectively in their daily lives.
- The design includes key elements like safe internet practices, use of digital tools, and online communication, helping viewers understand the importance of being digitally aware. I tried to make the design simple, colourful, and easy to understand so that it can reach a wider audience.
- One thing I found both difficult and interesting was creating a **repository on GitHub**. It was challenging to understand the steps at first, but once I learned it, I found it very useful for storing and sharing my work online. Overall, it was a great learning experience.

Task – 2

1. Chosen Platforms

For this project, the following three platforms were selected to build a comprehensive professional and technical foundation:

- **GitHub:** A cloud-based service for software development and version control using Git.
- **LinkedIn:** The world's largest professional networking site.
- **Kaggle:** An online community and platform for data scientists and machine learning practitioners.

2. Platform Usage and Four-Year Plan

The selection of GitHub, LinkedIn, and Kaggle provides a balanced approach to technical mastery, professional branding, and practical application.

GitHub will serve as my primary technical portfolio. Over the next four years, I will use it to host coursework, personal coding projects, and open-source contributions. This will create a "digital paper trail" of my coding growth, moving from basic scripts in Year 1 to complex, collaborative systems by Year 4.

LinkedIn is my professional identity hub. Initially, I will use it to connect with peers and alumni to explore career paths. Over the next four years, I plan to curate a professional brand by sharing project updates from GitHub and Kaggle, eventually utilizing the platform to secure internships and, ultimately, my first full-time role.

Kaggle will be my laboratory for data science and AI. I will use its datasets to practice real-world problem solving and participate in competitions to benchmark my skills against global peers. By Year 4, I aim to have a repository of high-quality "Notebooks" that demonstrate my analytical capabilities to potential employers.

Together, these platforms form a cohesive ecosystem for continuous learning and career readiness.

Task – 3

For this task, I focused on enhancing my technical proficiency and collaborative skills using HackerRank and Google Workspace. To satisfy the coding practice requirement, I utilized **HackerRank** to complete the "Solve Me First" challenge. This exercise allowed me to practice basic algorithm logic and input/output handling in a structured environment. On the collaboration front, I developed a "Digital Literacy Awareness Quiz" using **Google Forms**. This quiz consists of five targeted questions, ranging from multiple-choice inquiries about cybersecurity to short-answer reflections on digital footprints, ensuring a comprehensive assessment for my batchmates.

Academically, these tools are invaluable. HackerRank provides a disciplined environment for mastering programming languages, which is essential for succeeding in computer science coursework and technical assessments. Meanwhile, mastering Google Workspace facilitates seamless group projects and data collection for research. Being able to quickly create interactive forms and analyze responses in real-time through linked Google Sheets allows for efficient data-driven decision-making. As a Digital Ambassador, these platforms empower me to not only excel in my own studies but also effectively guide my peers in leveraging modern technology for academic success and professional growth.

Task – 4

Digital Ambassador Project Report: Task 4

As part of my responsibilities as a Digital Ambassador, I have completed the required professional email drafts and the social media etiquette checklist. This report analyzes a specific instance where poor digital communication led to significant consequences.

Case Analysis: The "Reply-All" Data Breach

A real-world problem frequently occurs when a sender accidentally uses the "Reply All" function for sensitive information. For example, a manager might send an email regarding a confidential performance review or a salary adjustment to a single employee, but mistakenly include a company-wide distribution list. In such a scenario, the employee's private data is instantly exposed to hundreds of colleagues, causing extreme embarrassment, a loss of trust, and potential legal liability for the company.

To prevent this, the manager should have double-checked the recipient list before clicking "Send." More importantly, organizations should utilize "Bcc" for large announcements to disable the "Reply All" capability for recipients. This situation highlights how a single second of technical oversight can undermine professional integrity.

Task – 5

Cybercrime Awareness Case Study & Prevention Guide

Role: Digital Ambassador **Date:** October 26, 2023

Part A: Case Study – UPI and Online Payment Fraud

The Crime: UPI (Unified Payments Interface) fraud involves tricking victims into authorizing unauthorized transactions or sharing sensitive credentials to siphon funds from their bank accounts.

How it Happens (Step-by-Step):

1. **The Hook:** A fraudster contacts the victim via a marketplace app (like OLX) or social media, expressing interest in buying an item the victim is selling.
2. **The "Payment" Link:** The attacker claims they want to pay immediately but sends a "Request Money" link or a QR code instead of a payment confirmation.
3. **The Deception:** The attacker tells the victim, "Scan this QR code and enter your PIN to receive the money."
4. **The Authorization:** Unaware that the PIN is only required for *sending* money, the victim enters their UPI PIN.
5. **The Theft:** The transaction is authorized, and funds are instantly transferred from the victim's account to the attacker's account.

Target Audience: Typically college students, small-scale online sellers, and elderly individuals who are comfortable using technology but unfamiliar with the specific mechanics of UPI requests.

Consequences: Victims face immediate financial loss, often ranging from a few thousand to several lakhs of rupees. Beyond the money, victims experience significant psychological distress, a loss of trust in

digital banking, and the arduous process of filing police complaints and bank disputes.

Part B: Prevention Checklist – 'Stay Safe Online'

Follow these 8 actionable tips to secure your digital presence, especially while studying in India:

1. **UPI Safety - Never Enter PIN to Receive:** Remember that your UPI PIN is only needed to *send* money. If someone asks you to enter your PIN or scan a QR code to *receive* a payment, it is a scam.
2. **UPI Safety - Verify Merchant Names:** Before clicking "Proceed" on any UPI app, double-check the verified name of the recipient displayed in the app to ensure it matches the person or business you intend to pay.
3. **Enable Two-Factor Authentication (2FA):** Activate 2FA on all social media accounts (Instagram, WhatsApp) and email. Use an authenticator app rather than just SMS if possible.
4. **Use Strong, Unique Passwords:** Avoid using your birthdate or "password123." Use a password manager to keep a unique, complex password for every platform.
5. **Be Skeptical of "Urgent" Messages:** If a friend messages you on WhatsApp asking for urgent money for a "medical emergency," call them directly on a normal cellular call to verify it is actually them.
6. **Secure Your Social Media Privacy:** Set your profiles to "Private" and regularly audit your "Followers" list. Do not accept requests from accounts that look suspicious or have no mutual friends.
7. **Avoid Public Wi-Fi for Banking:** Never log into your bank account or enter credit card details while connected to free college or cafe Wi-Fi. Use your mobile data instead.

8. **Check for 'HTTPS':** Before entering credentials on any website, ensure the URL starts with https:// and has a padlock icon, indicating a secure connection.

How to Report: If you are a victim of cybercrime, immediately contact:

National Helpline Number: 1930

Reflection: Research Insights

What surprised me most during this research was the sheer psychological sophistication used in "social engineering." I previously assumed cybercrime was mostly about complex coding or hacking into servers. However, I discovered that most modern frauds, especially UPI scams in India, rely on "human hacking"—exploiting a person's sense of urgency, greed, or helpfulness to make them bypass their own security common sense.

As a result of this study, the one habit I will personally change is my approach to QR codes and links. I used to scan QR codes at stalls or in messages quite casually. Moving forward, I have committed to a "Pause and Verify" rule: I will never scan a code or click a payment link without first verifying the source through a separate communication channel. Protecting my digital identity is no longer just about software updates; it's about maintaining a mindset of healthy skepticism.